

Telescope

The invention and improvement of telescopes gradually revealed the distant wonders of space.

The eye on the sky that brought the UNIVERSE into focus

Did you know?

The Kepler Space Telescope, launched in 2009, has a mission to find other earthlike planets beyond our Solar System.



Lippershey's lenses

In 1608, German-Dutch spectacle maker **Hans Lippershey** combined curved lenses in a long tube to make the **FIRST TELESCOPE**, which magnified objects up to three times. He went on to make several telescopes for the Dutch government, and was *paid very handsomely* in return.

It paved the way for...

The **CAT'S EYE NEBULA** is the remains of a dying star. Hubble has shown objects such as this in amazing detail.



Galileo

Italian scientist **GALILEO GALILEI** improved Lippershey's telescope in 1609 and turned it to the stars. His telescopes were able to *make distant objects appear bigger*, and gazing through them, he observed the craters of our Moon and four of Jupiter's moons, identified the fuzzy Milky Way as vast numbers of distant stars, and even realized that the **Earth orbits the Sun**.

The two **KECK TELESCOPES** in Hawaii have had their eyes on the cosmos **SINCE THE 1990s**. They observe visible and infrared light.

